

The Trial & The Contract

Patch tests, timelines, and the paperwork that prevents a wedding-day disaster

Learning Objectives

- Conduct a complete bridal trial including patch tests for every product involved
- Draft a bridal services contract covering deposit, cancellation, timeline, and liability
- Explain why the trial is evidence for the bride, not practice for the artist
- Manage a bride's expectations honestly during the trial conversation

The trial is not a rehearsal for you

A bridal trial exists so the bride can see and approve the look before the one day it cannot be redone — it is her evidence, not your dry run. Treat every element discussed in this module with the seriousness of a final decision, because for the client, that is exactly what it is.

Patch testing everything, without exception

Every product touching the bride's skin for the first time — foundation, lash adhesive, hairspray near the hairline, and critically, mehndi paste — must be patch tested at least forty-eight hours before both the trial and the wedding day itself, never on the day of either. A reaction discovered at the trial is a scheduling inconvenience. A reaction discovered on the wedding morning is a crisis with no time to fix it.

A Note from Practice

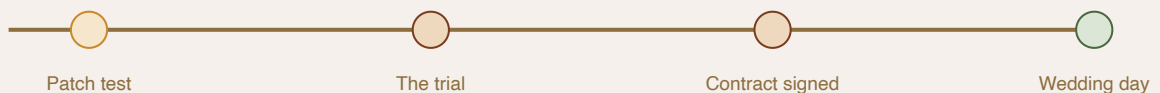
A bride requests a very dark, fast-staining mehndi design at her trial and asks for "the black henna, it's so much darker and faster." Black henna typically achieves its speed and colour through added para-phenylenediamine (PPD) — an industrial dye compound capable of causing severe allergic reactions, chemical burns, and permanent scarring on skin, and restricted or banned for skin application in many places for exactly this reason.

The correct response is a clear, confident decline: explain the PPD risk plainly, offer natural henna's genuine deep stain achieved through proper paste quality and dwell time instead, and never apply an unverified "black henna" product to a client's skin regardless of how firmly she requests it. Protecting a bride from a request she does not know is dangerous is part of the job, not an inconvenience to it.

The contract's essential clauses

- **Deposit and cancellation window.** A typically non-refundable deposit securing the date, with a clearly stated cancellation and rescheduling policy.
- **Timeline and buffer.** A written start time with built-in buffer, since bridal mornings run late more often than they run on time.
- **Liability disclaimer.** Clear disclosure of patch-test responsibility and known-allergy disclosure obligations on the client's side.
- **Travel and overtime fees.** Stated clearly up front, never negotiated for the first time on the wedding morning itself.

◆ Figure 3.1 · From Trial to Wedding Day



Never compress this sequence — each step exists to prevent a specific, foreseeable failure at the next one.

Key Terms

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[object Object]

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[object Object]

Practical Activity · Draft the Contract

Draft a one-page bridal services contract covering all four essential clauses from this module. Exchange with a partner and review each other's draft for any missing clause or ambiguous wording.